

YUEZHANG YAO

+86 18116293109 · yuezhangyao123@gmail.com · www.linkedin.com/in/yuezhangyao/

EDUCATION

Pepperdine University

Bachelor of Philosophy, Minor in French Studies

- President of the Chinese Student and Scholar Association
- Co-Founder of the Belonging Fellowship Award, Pepperdine

Sept 2018 – Apr 2023

Malibu, United States

Duke University

International Master of Environmental Policy

- Master Program Scholarship
- Graduate Student Representative at the Student Leader Board

Aug 2025 – May 2027

Kunshan/Durham

Core Principle & Key Course

- *Environmental Economics, Carbon Accounting, Program Evaluation, ESG, Just Transition, Environmental Law*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees, Jordan

Jan 2025- Oct 2025

Protection Consultant

- Authored detailed 10+ factsheets and progress reports for the communications team and donors, utilizing field research and data analytics to drive continuous improvement of the disability inclusion strategy.
- Compiled and summarized contributions from various field offices and programs to complete the comprehensive annual UNDIS report for NYHQ, providing a cohesive overview of UNRWA's efforts in advancing disability inclusion.
- Facilitated the implementation of UN Disability Inclusion Strategy (UNDIS) within UNRWA by collaborating with the HQ protection team on Integrated Assessments of 10+ UNRWA facilities close to the border of Israel, Lebanon, and Syria, ensure the facilities met established UN disability inclusion standards.
- Launched the DI trainings to more than 300 staff members in Gaza Field Office, raising awareness of disability inclusion to local staff members.

Swiss Chamber of Commerce – *Marketing and Event Assistant*

Aug 2024- Dec 2024

- Assisted in organizing events, roundtables, and webinars that foster international collaboration and promote sustainable business practices among Swiss and Chinese companies.
- Drafted and distributed daily email campaigns and WeChat posts, ensuring consistent and effective communication with members while highlighting key initiatives related to responsible business strategies.
- Supported the member benefit program, focusing on enhancing the value proposition for members committed to innovation and sustainable growth.

Illinois State Department of Commerce China Office – *Research Assistant*

July 2024- Dec 2024

- Conducted in-depth research and analysis on China-related commercial policies, focusing on their impact on sustainable and responsible business practices within the U.S. business community.
- Translated materials between Chinese and English to facilitate clear communication on compliance and governance matters, especially on the REV incentives of the State of Illinois.
- Prepared comprehensive reports on the State of Illinois' business environment, emphasizing developments in industries that prioritize ethical practices and long-term environmental and social responsibility.
- Organized Illinois' participation in the 2024 CIIIE, recruiting SMEs that demonstrate a commitment to sustainable and responsible business practices.

United Nations Environment Programme, Finance Initiative, Geneva – *HR and RC Intern*

July 2023-Feb 2024

- Supported the regional coordination team in assessing implementation progress of the Principles for Responsible Banking (PRB), contributing to survey design, data collection, and data cleaning for 350+ member banks. Used Microsoft Forms and Power BI to organize findings, conduct trend analysis, and support data inputs for the 2024 regional strategic planning process.
- Prepared regional analytical reports and presentation materials based on survey findings, synthesizing key issues, regional differences, and emerging trends. Presented the findings at the UNEP FI internal Roundtable, supporting strategic discussions on PRB implementation and management decision-making.
- Supported the project management team in personnel and contract processes for consultants and individual contractors. Processed approvals and reimbursement requests through Umoja, completing 130+ reimbursement reviews and entries per quarter while ensuring timeliness, accuracy, and procedural compliance.

Lufax Holding.Ltd, Shanghai, China -- Auditing Intern**Oct 2020-Apr 2021**

- Assisted in drafting the audit report of the annual project of Lufax for an external audit company, and awarded by "Outstanding Intern of the Department" for the third quarter of 2020.
- Utilized the company's internal training platform, "ZHINIAO", drafting cyber security course materials and assist in designing a series of cyber security test questions lists, leading the cumulative number of course completions to exceed 500 people, a 300% increase yearly.

China Financial Information Centre, Shanghai, China -- Administrative Intern**May 2018- Sept 2018**

- Coordinated a large-scale conference event for the CFIC, with 1,000 attendees, representing a 100% increase compared to the previous month.
- Tracked department projects' progress regularly by using track tools, wrote and published daily department project progress reports based on 10+ team members' performance, with a 100% completion rate.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

UNDP China, Yunnan, China -- UN Volunteer**Sept 2024- Dec 2024**

- Served as a volunteer teacher for the "Her and Digital Future" project, delivering a comprehensive, semester-long STEM curriculum to over 50 local students in a rural area in China.
- Integrated the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) into the curriculum, thereby broadening scientific perspectives and cultivating a heightened sense of social responsibility among students.
- Systematically gathered and analyzed student feedback and classroom data, subsequently authoring detailed progress and outcome reports that provided robust empirical evidence to support ongoing program enhancements and scalability.

Environment Research Center, DKU -- Research Assistant**Dec 2025- Jun 2026**

- Participated to the SROI (social return on investment) assessment of a public-interest coffee project in Nuijiang, Yunnan. Conducted field soil sampling and biodiversity monitoring across 7,000 mu of coffee plantations, and analyzed 30+ stakeholder interviews alongside secondary literature using Nvivo.
- Led the development of an ecological-economic coupling assessment framework to evaluate ecosystem service value and social outcomes, providing evidence-based insights and sustainability recommendations for the client.

Quzhou Central Landison Resort -- Acting Marketing Director**Dec 2024- Present**

- Directed end-to-end hotel marketing and growth strategy across Ctrip, Meituan, and Tiktok, optimizing the business funnel from content acquisition and livestream conversion to transaction and fulfillment.
- Led 10+ iterations of product packages, livestream pacing, content strategy, and conversion pathways based on user feedback and performance data, driving the hotel project from RMB 1 million in cumulative losses to break-even and reached RMB 1 million+ in quarterly Tiktok GMV.

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Languages:

- **Mandarin:** Native
- **English:** Professional & Academic Proficiency
- **French:** Confident in Reading and Writing
- **Spanish:** Intermediate

Analytical Skills & Communication Skills:

- Stata, GIS, Powerbi, Python, VS code, Excel, Microsoft Word, Outlook, Powerpoint, Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Canvas, Wordpress

CERTIFICATE AND REWARDS

- National Scholarship for International Organization Internship -- *Chinese Student Council*
- Synergizing Disaster Risk Reduction and Climate Adaption -- *UNDRR*
- South South and Triangular Cooperation -- *UNOSSC*
- Green Marketing Challenge -- *UNSSC*